THE WORKSHEET PACK

The 13 Internomics Tools

Internomics: How to See the Game Behind Every Interaction

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MODULE 0 · ORIENTATION: THE GAME BEHIND THE CONVERSATION

The Interaction Journal

> **The question:** What if the way we normally think about communication starts too late?

Use one page per interaction. You'll add a new column of questions in each module.

Date / setting: _____

Who was involved (including people not in the room):

_____

What I wanted: _____

What I think they wanted: _____

What I said or did: _____

How they responded: _____

Did their response surprise me? What might that tell me?

_____

If I could replay it, what question would I ask myself before speaking?

_____

MODULE 1 · SEE THE GAME

The Game Map

> **The question:** What's really going on here?

Use this before any important interaction. Write short answers and don’t aim for perfection. The goal is to train your attention, not to complete a form.

The interaction: _____

WHO?

- Who are the relevant players? _____
- Who can actually affect the outcome, including anyone not in the room?

  _____

WHAT?

- What does each person want? _____
- Where are our interests aligned? _____
- Where are they different? _____

OPTIONS?

- What can each player actually do? _____

CONSTRAINTS?

- What limits those choices? _____
- Which constraints are stated, and which do I know are real?

  _____

INFORMATION?

- Who knows what? _____
- Who doesn’t know what? _____

TIMING?

- Who moves first? _____
- Who responds? _____
- What can each person observe before choosing? _____

ALTERNATIVES?

- What happens if there is no agreement, for me and for them?

  _____

DEPENDENCIES?

- Who needs whom? _____
- Who has alternatives? _____

THEN WHAT?

- If I make this move, what is the other person likely to do next? _____
- And what would I do after that? _____

Final check

- Could there be a game behind the conversation, such as credit, trust, status, authority, or precedent? _____
- Is this a person problem or a game problem? _____
- What am I failing to notice about the game? _____

MODULE 2 · SEE THE PAYOFFS

The Payoff Map

> **The question:** What payoff would make their behavior make sense?

Use this map before any important interaction. It sits on top of your Game Map from Module 1.

The interaction: _____

Players (from your Game Map): _____

1. What do I want?

What outcomes matter to me? (List more than one currency.)

2. What do they want?

What outcomes appear to matter to them? (Not what they should want, not what I'd want in their shoes, not only what they said.)

3. Where do our interests align?

What can we both gain?

4. Where do they conflict?

What does one person gain at the other's expense?

5. What are we each trying to avoid?

What losses or risks matter? (Me / Them)

6. What might I be missing?

Could status, identity, fairness, autonomy, or relationships matter here?

7. Interest structure (circle one): Mostly opposed · Mostly aligned · Mixed

The most important question: Am I assuming their payoff is the same as mine?

My next move, given this map (and one that respects their autonomy and informed choice):

MODULE 3 · THINK IN RESPONSES

The Response Map

> **The question:** "If I do this, what are they likely to do next? And if they do that, what will I do?"

Part 1 is the chapter's practical exercise for an interaction that went sideways. Part 2 turns the chapter's questions into a pre-move check.

Part 1 — Rewind a past interaction

Pick a recent interaction that didn't go the way you wanted. Don't judge who was right yet; just write the sequence.

1. What did I do? _____
2. What did they do? _____
3. What did I do next? _____
4. What did they do next? _____
5. (Continue if needed) _____

- At which point did the interaction change direction? _____
- What could I have predicted about their response before making my move?

  _____

Part 2 — Map an upcoming move

1. **My planned move** (what I'm about to say or do): _____
2. **What I want them to do** (my intention): _____
3. **Their side of the board.** Given their preferences, not mine:
   - Their goals: _____
   - What they know (and don't): _____
   - Their options: _____
   - Their constraints (boss, money, time, reputation, emotions):

     _____
4. **What does this move make them want to do?** Several plausible responses, each marked:
   - Response A: _____ (likely / possible / unlikely)
   - Response B: _____ (likely / possible / unlikely)
   - Response C: _____ (likely / possible / unlikely)

5. **Intention check:** Does my move actually make the response I want more attractive than their alternatives? _____
6. **If they do that, what will I do?** (One line per response above.)

   _____
7. **Where does the sequence lead?** (High stakes only.) _____
8. **Eliminate:** Is any option worse for me regardless of what they do?

   _____
9. **Threat check:** If a threat is involved (theirs or mine), would carrying it out be the best response when the moment comes? _____
10. **Pattern and relevance:** What pattern will this move create? Which response could materially change the outcome? _____
11. **Afterward — update:** What did they actually do? Where was my prediction off, and what did I misunderstand about the game? _____

MODULE 4 · MANAGE PREDICTABILITY

The Predictability Audit

> **The question:** What does my predictability enable the other player to do?

Use this on one recurring interaction where a pattern may be shaping the game.

Step 1 — Name the interaction

The person or group: _____

The recurring situation (meeting, negotiation, household routine, request):

_____

Step 2 — Find the pattern

What do I repeatedly do in this situation? _____

What have my past actions taught this person to expect from me?

_____

Have I taught this person how to respond to me? If so, what is the rule they've learned (finish the sentence "If I **, she/he will** ")? _____

Did I choose this rule, or did my repeated behavior establish it?

_____

Step 3 — Calculate the predictability tax

What does this pattern reveal that I didn't intend to reveal (my limits, availability, whether my threats or boundaries are real)? _____

Step 4 — Asset or liability?

Who benefits from knowing what I'm going to do? (Circle one: both of us / mainly them / mainly me)

Is this pattern helping me? Helping them? Helping both of us?

_____

Could they exploit this pattern? How? _____

Check any that apply. This pattern currently: - [ ] creates trust, cooperation, or a credible commitment - [ ] helps others coordinate with me - [ ] shows people exactly how to pressure me - [ ] reveals threats, concessions, or unenforced boundaries

Step 5 — Choose your move

Would greater consistency create trust — or greater flexibility create strategic room?

_____

Which of the four moves fits? (Circle one) - **Be predictable** — trust, coordination, credibility, or cooperation are valuable here. - **Protect my predictability** — revealing my pattern gives them leverage. - **Vary my behavior** — they could otherwise exploit a fixed pattern. - **Be deliberately consistent** — I want them to understand a consequence is real.

The specific behavior I'll change or reinforce: _____

Step 6 — Ethics check

Am I protecting legitimate information or providing false information?

_____

Could my change destabilize someone or make me harder to trust where reliability matters?

_____

MODULE 5 · SEE THE EQUILIBRIUM

The Equilibrium Audit

> **The question:** What equilibrium have we created?

Use this when you're stuck in a recurring interaction. Work through it in writing, at a calm moment.

The situation (one line): _____

1. What keeps happening? Forget the individual incident. Describe the repeated pattern as a loop (my move, their response, my response…). _____

_____

2. What does my behavior cause them to do? _____

3. What does their behavior cause me to do? _____

4. Why might neither of us want to change unilaterally? If I changed alone, what would I risk? If they changed alone, what would they risk? Me: _____ Them: _____

5. Is this pattern actually good for either of us? What does each of us get from maintaining it? What does it cost each of us? _____

6. Are there alternative stable patterns? Describe at least one other pattern that could hold steady if we both settled into it. _____

Equilibrium check: Is this really equilibrium-like, or is it held in place by something else (habit, a rule, coercion, lack of awareness)? Would changing alone actually make someone worse off? _____

The most important question: What would have to change for a different pattern to become attractive? Check any levers that apply, then describe one: - [ ] My response - [ ] The sequence (who moves first, when) - [ ] The incentives - [ ] New information - [ ] A commitment - [ ] A third party - [ ] Expectations about what the other will do - [ ] The available choices

My first experiment: _____

MODULE 6 · MAP INFORMATION & BELIEFS

The Information Map

> **The question:** "What do they know—or believe—that I don't?"

Use this before any important interaction, or after one that confused you. The first seven questions are the chapter's Information Map. The sorting table and the final checks help you keep facts, beliefs, and assumptions in separate columns.

The situation: _____

The other player(s): _____

Part 1 — The seven questions

1. **What do I know?** (Separate facts from assumptions.) _____
2. **What don't I know?** (Identify the uncertainty.) _____
3. **What do they know that I don't?** (Look for information asymmetry.)

   _____
4. **What do I know that they don't?** (Recognize your own informational advantage.)

   _____
5. **What do I think they believe?** (Model their beliefs.) _____
6. **What do they think I believe?** (If the stakes are high, this matters too.)

   _____
7. **What evidence could change my mind?** (Protect yourself from your own assumptions.)

   _____

Part 2 — Sort it

Layer	Question	My answer
Facts	What do I actually know happened? (Observable, verifiable.)	
Unknowns	What relevant information am I missing?	
Beliefs	What do I currently think is true?	
Assumptions about them	What am I assuming they know or believe?	

For each belief, mark your confidence: **I know / I have good evidence / I suspect / I'm guessing.** _____

Part 3 — Shared or common?

- Is the key information actually in their information set? What evidence do I have that they know it? _____
- Do we both know that we both know it, or am I assuming it's shared?

  _____

Part 4 — Messages I'm relying on

- What did they tell me that matters? _____
- What do they gain if I believe it? What would it cost them if it were false?

  _____
- How could I verify it? _____
- **Why should I believe it?** _____

Part 5 — Decision-relevant information

- What single piece of information would change my decision, or theirs?

  _____
- How can I get it (ask, observe, verify, share)? _____

MODULE 7 · SEPARATE WORDS FROM CREDIBILITY

The Credibility Test

> **The question:** What makes this message credible?

Use this for high-stakes claims, not for directions to the restroom.

The claim (in their words): _____

What decision of mine does it affect? _____

Part 1 — The eight questions

1. **Do they know?** Are they in a position to possess this information?
   _____
2. **What do they want me to believe?** _____
3. **What happens if I believe them?** How does my response affect their payoff?
   _____
4. **Would they say this even if it were false?** If yes, the words alone may not be highly informative. _____
5. **What evidence supports the claim?** Assertion: _____
   Verification: _____
6. **What does their behavior suggest?** (Evidence, not proof.)
   _____
7. **What does their history suggest?** _____
8. **What would make this claim costly to fake?** _____

Part 2 — Separate the dimensions (high / medium / low / unknown)

- Honesty: _____ because _____
- Knowledge: _____ because _____
- Incentive alignment: _____ because _____

Part 3 — Persuasive versus credible

- How convincing did it feel (confidence, charisma, emotion)?
  _____
- How credible is the underlying claim? _____
- Did it change my mind, or give me good reason to change my mind?
  _____
- What verification is available, and is it worth getting? _____

Part 4 — Speaker's side (when you're the one making the claim)

- What reason does the other person have to believe me? _____
- Is this a message problem or a credibility problem? _____
- How can I make my truthful claim easier to evaluate? _____

MODULE 8 · COMMITMENT CHANGES THE GAME

The Commitment Test

> **The question:** What makes this commitment real?

Use this before making a threat, promise, deadline, boundary, or "final" position, and to evaluate one someone else makes to you.

The situation

The commitment I'm considering (or facing), and whether it's an intention, promise, or strategic commitment: _____

Part 1 — What makes this commitment real?

What actually binds it? (contract / rule / third-party authority / legal restriction / public commitment / financial consequence / reputational cost / irreversible investment / merely words) _____

Can the other player observe or verify it? _____

Part 2 — What am I giving up, and why?

What future option am I giving up? (Be precise.) _____

What strategic benefit does the constraint create? _____

Part 3 — Threats and promises

"If you _____, I will _____."
Threat or promise? _____

When the moment arrives, will carrying it out still make sense? Is there a smaller consequence I would enforce every time? _____

Part 4 — Boundaries

"If this occurs, here is what I will do": _____

What I will actually do, calmly and consistently, when it's crossed:

_____

Part 5 — Their response

How will their best response change (concede, walk away, commit back, find alternatives, retaliate, stop)? _____

Can this produce an impasse? What if they refuse to move?

_____

Part 6 — The costs of commitment

What happens if new information appears? What flexibility will I wish I still had?

_____

Is this strategy, or stubbornness and sunk cost? _____

Part 7 — Ethics

Does it preserve truth, autonomy, dignity, and informed choice?

_____

Decision: Commit as planned / commit to something smaller or more enforceable / stay flexible. Why? _____

MODULE 9 · THE SHADOW OF THE FUTURE

The Repeated-Game Audit

> **The question:** What changes because there is a next time?

Use this when an interaction is likely to continue. Don't evaluate it as though it ends today.

The interaction: _____

The move I'm tempted to make: _____

Step 1 — Is there a next round? Is there likely to be a next round? (yes / no / unsure) _____ How valuable is that future interaction to me? To them? _____ Is an endpoint visible (last day, final contract, move away)? _____

Step 2 — Transaction or relationship? Is this a transaction that ends when the exchange ends, or a relationship that creates another round? _____

Step 3 — Teaching and learning What is today's move teaching the other person to expect from me? _____ What am I learning about them? _____ What does their history tell me (reliable for years, or "here we go again")? _____

Step 4 — Reputation What reputation are we each building? _____ Is that reputation useful predictability, or exploitable predictability? _____ What reputation do I want to be bound by? _____

Step 5 — Incentives What behavior am I rewarding? _____ What behavior am I making costly? _____

Step 6 — Repair If a mistake occurs, is there a path back to cooperation? _____ How would I tell a mistake from exploitation? _____

Step 7 — The hundred-round test What happens if we keep playing this way for the next hundred rounds? _____

My move, revised: _____

MODULE 10 · DIAGNOSE THE COORDINATION PROBLEM

The Coordination Diagnostic

> **The question:** Are we actually in conflict—or are we failing to coordinate?

Use this when a group or relationship keeps producing an outcome nobody seems to want.

The bad outcome that keeps happening (no character judgments):

_____

1. Do we actually want incompatible things? If yes, you may have a conflict or bargaining problem. If partly, note: Where we align: _____ Where we diverge: _____

2. Would I take the desired action if I knew the others would too? My honest answer: _____ What I suspect others would honestly answer: _____ (Yes → likely coordination. "I'd rather others bear the cost" → likely social dilemma; clarity alone may not fix it.)

3. My diagnosis (circle one): Conflict / Coordination failure / Social dilemma / Mixed Why:

_____

4. What am I uncertain about? (their actions, intentions, knowledge, commitment)

_____

5. What are they uncertain about? (Your intentions may be part of the problem.)

_____

6. What expectation needs to become mutually clear? Who acts? _____ When? _____ According to what standard? _____ Where is the handoff?

_____

7. Is there a focal point or convention we can coordinate around?

_____

8. Does everyone know that everyone knows? Would making it public change the game? _____

9. Choose the intervention:

- ☐ A shared plan
- ☐ A public commitment
- ☐ A clear owner
- ☐ A standard
- ☐ A deadline

☐ A focal point

☐ Information about what everyone else intends to do

My one sentence that makes the next move obvious to everyone:

_____

Ethics check: Does this respect truth, autonomy, dignity, and informed choice for everyone affected? _____

MODULE 11 · CHANGE THE GAME

The Game-Change Audit

> **The question:** Do I need a better move—or a better game?

Use this when the same bad outcome keeps returning, after better arguments, better wording, more motivation, and more pressure haven't fixed it.

Step 1 — Name the recurring problem

The outcome that keeps returning: _____

What I (or we) have already tried, inside the current game:

_____

My current character explanation ("they're lazy / selfish / gaming it"):

_____

Step 2 — What does the game actually reward?

What behavior is the current game rewarding? (Not what the policy claims to reward. What actually pays?) _____

What behavior is it punishing? Could the desirable action currently be costly?

_____

What metric are people optimizing? Is it actually the outcome we care about?

_____

What does my stated value say, and what does the reward say?

_____

Step 3 — Inspect the levers

Lever	How it works now	One possible change
Rules: what players can and can't do		
Payoffs: what pays, what costs		
Information: who knows what, when		
Who decides		

Lever	How it works now	One possible change
Timing: who moves when		
Options: what choices exist		
Players: could a third party help?		
Observability and feedback		
Default: what happens if nobody acts		

What is currently easy? _____

What is currently hard? (Friction is part of the design.) _____

Is there an incentive or rule I should remove rather than add?

_____

Step 4 — Stress-test the redesign

How could a smart player game this system, including my new version of it?

_____

What unintended behavior might the new rule create? (Think one response further: then what?) _____

What harder-to-measure work might lose effort if I reward the measurable part?

_____

Step 5 — Ethics check

Does the player understand the game? _____

Do they retain meaningful choice? _____

Are important facts hidden, or does the system exploit confusion?

_____

Does it treat people as decision-makers rather than objects to be manipulated?

_____

Step 6 — Smallest testable change

What specific mechanism appears to be producing the unwanted behavior?

_____

The smallest change capable of testing that hypothesis: _____

What I’ll observe, and when: _____

If exit is on the table: what would I lose, and what future would I give up?

_____

The central question: Can I redesign the game so that the behavior I want becomes a more natural response to the structure itself? _____

MODULE 12 · STRATEGIC JUDGMENT

The Strategic Judgment Worksheet

> **The question:** What did I learn from what just happened?

Use this when the stakes matter, something doesn't make sense, a pattern keeps repeating, incentives are unclear, trust is uncertain, or several people affect the outcome. Don't use it for "Sure."

Part 1 — The situation

What happened (facts only): _____

My first interpretation (my story): _____

How confident am I in that story (0–100%)? _____

What is my immediate impulse, the thing I'd say or do with no pause?

_____

Part 2 — The Eleven Questions (scan all, mark the 2–3 that matter most)

✓	Model	Question	My answer
☐	1. See the Game	What game am I actually in? (Players, actions, timing, outside options, who can combine with whom)	_____
☐	2. See the Payoffs	What does each player actually value? Are our interests opposed, aligned, or mixed?	_____
☐	3. Think in Responses	Then what? Is there an option I shouldn't choose regardless of what they do?	_____

✔	Model	Question	My answer
☐	4. Manage Predictability	What should they be able to predict about me, and what becomes exploitable if they can?	_____
☐	5. See the Equilibrium	What pattern are we producing, and why is it stable?	_____
☐	6. Map Information & Beliefs	What do I know, what am I assuming, and what might they know that I don't?	_____
☐	7. Separate Words From Credibility	What makes this believable?	_____
☐	8. Commitment Changes the Game	What actually binds them, or me?	_____
☐	9. The Shadow of the Future	What changes because there is a next time?	_____
☐	10. Diagnose the Coordination Problem	Are we actually in conflict, or failing to coordinate? (If everyone else cooperated, would I still have an incentive not to?)	_____
☐	11. Change the Game	Do I need a better move, or a better game?	_____

The 2–3 lenses that matter most, and why: _____

The lenses I'm deliberately setting aside, and why: _____

Part 3 — Competing hypotheses

Hypothesis about what's going on	Evidence for	What would tell this apart from the others?
H1: _____	_____	_____

Hypothesis about what's going on	Evidence for	What would tell this apart from the others?
H2: _____	_____	_____
H3: _____	_____	_____

What would have to be true for their behavior to make sense?

_____

Part 4 — The move

My planned move: _____

What I predict will happen: _____

Will this work? _____

Should I do it? Check each: - Truth: Am I saying only what I believe is true and not creating a false impression? _____ - Autonomy: Does the other person stay free to choose, including to say no? _____ - Dignity: Would I be comfortable if they saw my full reasoning? _____ - Informed choice: Do they have the information they'd need to decide well?

_____

What are we cooperating toward? _____

Is the right move vulnerability, walking away, or refusing this game?

_____

The Practice Log: Model → Act → Observe → Update → Adapt

Keep one entry per meaningful interaction. Over weeks, this log is how your intuition gets calibrated.

Date	Model (my read + key lens)	Act (what I did)	Prediction	Observe (what actually happened)	Update (where reality differed, and why)	Adapt (new strategy or new model)

Surprise prompts for the Update column: - They didn't cooperate. What did I misunderstand? _____ - They stayed. What payoff did I underestimate? _____ - They followed through. What made the commitment stronger than I realized? _____ - My rule or design backfired. What response did it create that I didn't anticipate?

_____